

Glossary

Appliqué One piece of fabric being stitched to another in a decorative manner.

Armhole Opening in a garment for the sleeve and arm.

Back stitch A strong hand stitch with a double stitch on the wrong side.

Bias 45-degree line on fabric that falls between the lengthways and the crossways grain.

Bias binding Narrow strips of fabric cut on the bias. Used to give a neat finish.

Binding Method of finishing a raw edge by wrapping it in a strip of bias-cut fabric.

Blanket stitch Hand stitch worked along the raw or finished edge of fabric to neaten, and for decorative purposes.

Bobbin Round holder beneath the needle plate of a sewing machine on which the thread is wound.

Centre back The vertical line of symmetry of a pattern back piece.

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Cotton Soft, durable, and inexpensive fabric widely used. Made from the fibrous hairs covering the seed pods of the cotton plant.

Cutting mat Self-healing mat used in conjunction with a rotary cutter to protect the blade and the cutting surface.

Dart Tapered, stitched fold of fabric used to give shape and contour to a sewn item.

Ease Distributing fullness in fabric when joining two seams together of slightly different lengths, for example a sleeve to an armhole.

Facing Layer of fabric placed on the inside of a garment and used to finish off raw edges of an armhole or neck of a garment. Usually a separate piece of fabric, the facing can sometimes be an extension of the garment itself.

Felt A nonwoven fabric or group of fibres matted together through heat, moisture, and pressure.

Flat fell stitch A strong, secure stitch used to hold two layers together permanently. Often used to secure bias bindings.

Freezer paper A treated paper used to store frozen foods. One side has a lightly waxed surface that will stick to fabric when ironed. It is available in some major supermarkets and online.

Hem The edge of a piece of fabric neaten and stitched to prevent unravelling. There are several methods of doing this, both by hand and by machine.

Hem allowance Amount of fabric allowed for turning under to make the hem.

Interfacing A fabric placed between garment and facing to give structure and support. Available in different thicknesses, interfacing can be fusible (bonds to the fabric by applying heat) or non-fusible (needs to be sewn to the fabric).

Jersey Cotton or wool yarn that has been knitted to give stretch.

Mitre The diagonal line made where two edges of a piece of fabric meet at a corner, produced by folding. *See also* Mitred corner.

Mitred corner Diagonal seam formed when fabric is joined at a corner. Excess fabric is cut away before or after stitching.

Notion An item of haberdashery, other than fabric, needed to complete a project, such as a button, zip, or elastic.

Pinking A method of neatening raw edges of fray-resistant fabric using pinking shears. This will leave a zigzag edge.

Pinking shears Cutting tool with serrated blades, used to trim raw edges of fray-resistant fabrics to neaten seam edges.

